

KF Reading Guide for HPKP¹

Chapters 3 & 4: *Patronage and Grace*

Chapter Three: Patronage and Reciprocity

1. Let's consider the "market economy" of America and northern Europe (95.1–96.1)
 - A. How do we get what we need or want?
 - B. How is exchange measured out?
 - C. We are most often hired on what basis?
 - D. What is a bureaucratized right when people fall into hard times?
 - E. How is citizenship and its rights attained?
2. In New Testament times, what was the essential means of accessing goods, protection, and opportunities for employment and advancement? (96.2)
3. According to a first-century participant, what did the practice of giving and receiving favors constitute? (96.2)

Patronage and Friendship

4. What did the market economy provide? (96.3)
5. What marks the long-term relationship between the patron and the client? (97.1)
6. What is the bedrock of both friendship and the relationship between patrons and clients? (99.1)
7. According to Dr. deSilva's definition of friendship, how did Jesus see His disciples when he called them friends (John 15:9-17)? (99.1)

8. Great prestige is attached to what good reputation? (100.2)

9. What does personal patronage involve? (101, footnote 16).

The Social Context of Grace

10. For New Testament Christians, the word *grace* was used primarily to speak of what? (104.2)

11. What are the three components of grace? (104.3–105.1)

A.

B.

C.

12. What did Greek and Roman cultures state explicitly about grace? (105.2)

13. Describe the dance of the Graces? (106.1)

Showing Favor (Grace)

14. What was a highly valued characteristic in New Testament times? (106.4)

15. Consider the codes of conduct for the giver. (106.5–108.2)

A. The giver must not act from what?

B. Whom should the giver scrutinize?

C. What does the noble giver evaluate?

16. What advice is given for making friends? (108, footnote 34)

Responding with Grace

17. How is the virtue of justice defined? (110.2)

18. What does the person embody who returns grace for grace? (111.1)

19. From what does the patron's power come? (112, footnote 44)

20. As we consider gratitude, what paradox is presented to us? (113.2)

21. What should both parties receive from the friendship in personal patronage? (114.1)

22. Let's consider four components of gratitude.

A. What is part of the proper return for a benefit? (114:1)

B. What is a second component of gratitude? (114:3)

C. How does the client "keep faith"? (115.2)

D. What would the grateful person look for? (116:2)

23. What was the ultimate goal for these ancient ethicists? (118.2)

24. What did grace hold together? (118.3)

Chapter Four: Patronage and Grace in the New Testament

1. Early converts would have understood that receiving gifts “given freely” placed them under what obligation? (122.2)

God the Benefactor and Patron

2. Why do both Jews and Gentiles have the same standing before God? (127.1)
3. What is an important component of the New Testament message about God’s beneficence (128.2)
4. How is the supreme, fullest generosity of God expressed? (129.2)
5. What is the second aspect of God’s favor that stands out? (129.3)
6. What does God’s favor communicate to us and how is this shown? (129, footnote 16)
7. In what way does Jesus act as a mediator and broker between human beings and God? (130.1)
8. What motivates God’s generosity according to 2 Peter 1:3? (130.2)
9. What is rather distinctive about God’s favor? (130.3–131.1)
10. Why pray if God already knows our needs? (132.1)

Jesus, the Mediator of God’s Favor

11. What five benefits did Jesus offer in His ministry that derived from His relationship to God? (133.4–134.2)

- A.
- B.
- C.
- D.
- E.

12. Which of these benefits could we, as representatives of God, offer to others?

13. What is the crowning benefaction conferred by Jesus? (136.2)

14. What has Jesus opened up for His clients? (137.2)

15. How does Paul view his own apostleship? (138.2)

16. What strong assurance does the history of God's generosity give to Christians? (140.2)

Making a Gracious Response

17. What does an awareness of the first century ethos of grace contribute to our present understanding? (141.2)

18. What is the first component of a fulsome response of gratitude? (142.1)

19. What falls to the recipient of favor? (142.2)

20. How is evangelism and witness most effectively done? (143.1)
21. What also results in the increase of the honor given to Jesus' name (His reputation)? (143.2)
22. What is also a vital part of gratitude? (144.1)
23. What does loyalty to God mean? (144.2–145.1)
24. What is the other side of loyalty? (145.2)
25. What does firm trust in God become? (145.2)
26. In what other way can clients return gratitude? (145.3)
27. In essence, what is sanctification? (147.2)
28. What do divine endowments become? (148.1)

Ungraceful Responses to God's Beneficence

29. What dangers do the Christian Scriptures present to us? (149.1)
30. Which of these ugly unsuitable courses of action distress you most? (149.2)

Christian Giving

31. To whom can we sometimes feel under greater obligations? (152, footnote 63)
32. On what basis are Christians called upon to share with one another? (153.2)
33. Participating in relief efforts is presented as what? (154.1)
34. What can be exchanged in the reciprocal relationships between believers and churches? (154, footnote 66)

Conclusion

35. What becomes the focal points for our understanding of our lives as Christians? (155.1)
36. What is the result of that understanding? (155.1)
37. What defaces the beauty and the nobility of a karis relationship? (155.2)
38. What is a more natural motivation for engaging in evangelism? (155.3)
39. What happens when our ambitions are channeled toward God's good gifts? (156.2)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 2000 edition of *Honor, Patronage, Kinship & Purity* by David A. deSilva, published by Inter Varsity Press, Downers Grove, IL.